

MAINE VOTER SURVEY

September 2026

FabrizioWard + IMPACT RESEARCH

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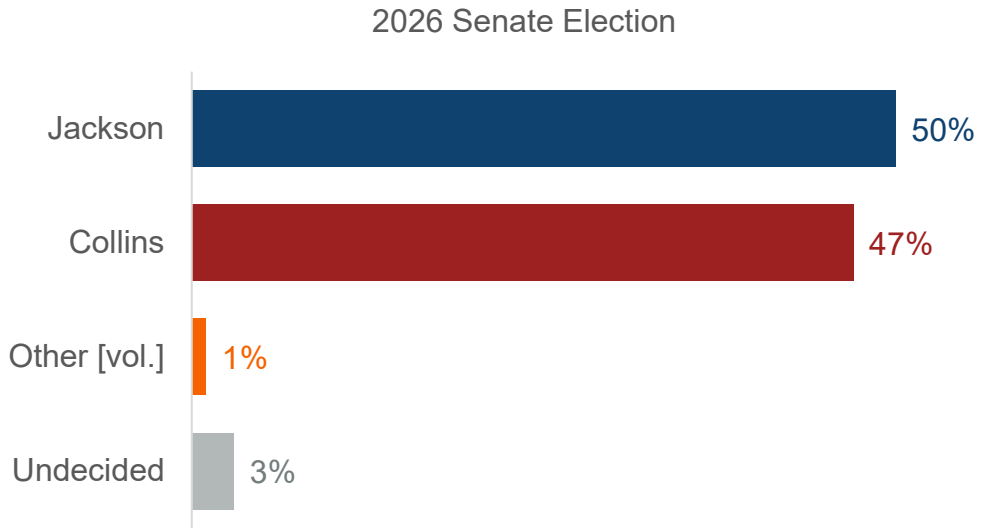
MAINE: BATTLEGROUND STATE

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Senate contest

Troy Jackson (D) has a slight edge over Sen. Susan Collins (R), 50% - 47%, with only 3% of voters undecided.

- The race is marked by a wide age divide with Jackson's 25-point lead among voters under 50 driven by a big advantage among voters 18-34. Collins has a 9-point lead among voters 50+.
- While both get similar levels of support among their partisan bases, Maine has more Democrats, so the advantage is Jackson's. Independents split, and there's a large difference with younger ones backing Jackson and older ones supporting Collins.
- There is a modest gender gap, but a large educational attainment gap with voters without degrees supporting Collins by 14-points and those with 4-year degrees voting for Jackson by 28.
- Swing Voters 50+, those who don't vote straight party ticket, make up 20% of the 50+ electorate and heavily support Collins, keeping her in the race.



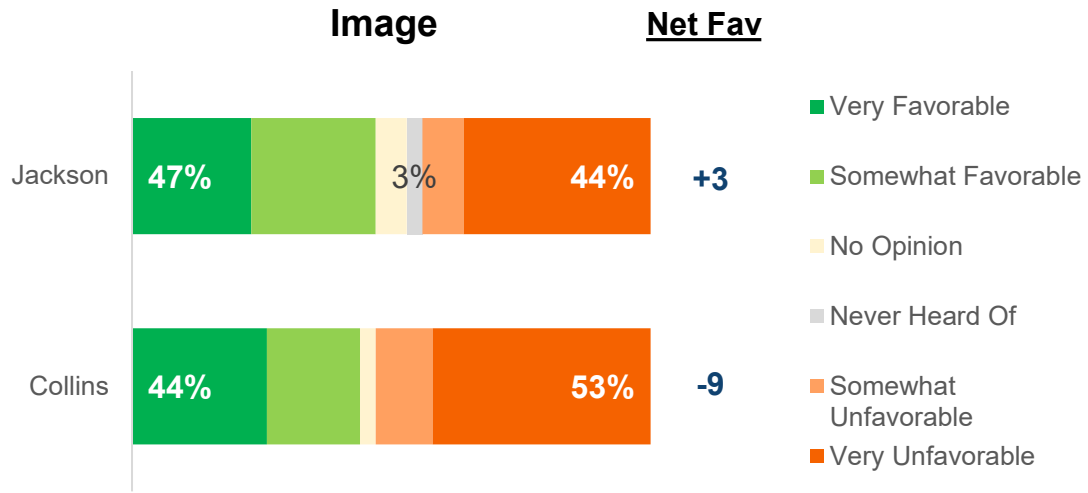
	All likely voters	Voters 18-49	Voters 50+	Voters 18-34	Voters 35-49	Voters 50-64	Voters 65+	GOP	Ind	Dem	GOP 18-49	GOP 50+	Ind 18-49	Ind 50+	Dem 18-49	Dem 50+	Women	Men	Women 50+	Men 50+	<Coll	Coll +	CD-1	CD-2	Care-givers 50+	Swing Voters 50+
Net Jackson	**+3**	**+25**	**-9**	**+47**	**+9**	**-12**	**-7**	**-80**	**+1**	**+77**	**-76**	**-81**	**+30**	**-20**	**+84**	**+73**	**+10**	**-4**	**-4**	**-17**	**-14**	**+28**	**+16**	**-11**	**-12**	**-53**
Jackson	50	60	44	71	53	43	45	9	47	88	10	9	60	38	92	85	53	47	46	41	41	63	56	43	43	17
Collins	47	35	53	24	44	55	52	89	46	11	86	90	30	58	8	12	43	51	50	58	55	35	40	54	55	70
Other/Und	3	5	3	5	3	2	3	2	7	1	4	1	10	4	0	3	4	2	4	1	4	2	4	3	2	13

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Senate: Images

Troy Jackson's image is 47% - 44%, while Susan Collins is in negative territory at 44% - 53%.

- Like on the ballot, voters 18-34 are driving Jackson's positives and Collins' negatives. Collins is at +7 on her image among voters 50+ while Jackson is -7.
- Both candidates are narrowly underwater among Independents, with Jackson a bit better off than Collins. Again, there is a significant divide by age.
- Collins' image overall is negative due to women voters. Notably women 50+ are evenly divided on both Collins and Jackson.
- Also similar to the ballot, the educational attainment divide on both candidates' images is very large.



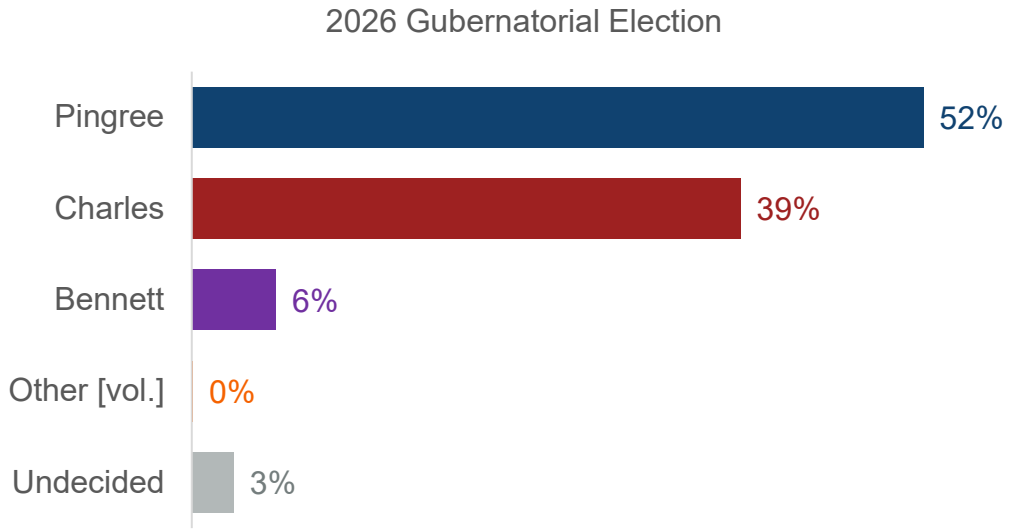
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Jackson Net Fav	+3	+18	-7	+35	+6	-10	-4	-72	-4	+73	-73	-73	+13	-16	+79	+68	+8	-4	-2	-12	-13	+24	+13	-9	-8	-37
Favorable	47	54	42	63	48	42	42	9	42	83	7	9	49	38	88	79	48	44	44	40	37	60	51	41	42	23
Unfavorable	44	36	49	28	42	52	46	81	46	10	80	82	36	54	9	11	40	48	46	52	50	36	38	50	50	60
Collins Net Fav	-9	-32	+7	-55	-17	+8	+4	+74	-11	-78	+61	+80	-38	+11	-86	-72	-17	+2	-3	+17	+10	-33	-20	+5	+9	+27
Favorable	44	32	52	20	40	52	51	86	42	10	78	89	27	54	7	12	40	49	47	57	53	33	38	51	53	59
Unfavorable	53	64	45	75	57	44	47	12	53	88	17	9	65	43	93	84	57	47	50	40	43	66	58	46	44	32

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Gubernatorial contest

Hannah Pingree (D) has a clear 52% - 39% lead over Robert 'Bobby' Charles (R) with Rick Bennett (I) getting 6% and 3% undecided.

- Pingree leads among both voters under 50 and 50+, with her lead biggest among those 18-34, but she is also up double-digits among seniors, who vote a net 21-points differently between the Senate and Governor's races.
- Pingree has Democrats more united behind her than Charles has Republicans behind him, and she's also up 9-points among Independents.
- Unlike the Senate race, where Collins is up among older Independents, Pingree has a slight lead with this group.
- Pingree not only leads among women overall, but she has a sizable edge among women 50+.
- Swing voters 50+ favor Pingree over Charles by 28-points. Bennett is in 2nd place with this group.

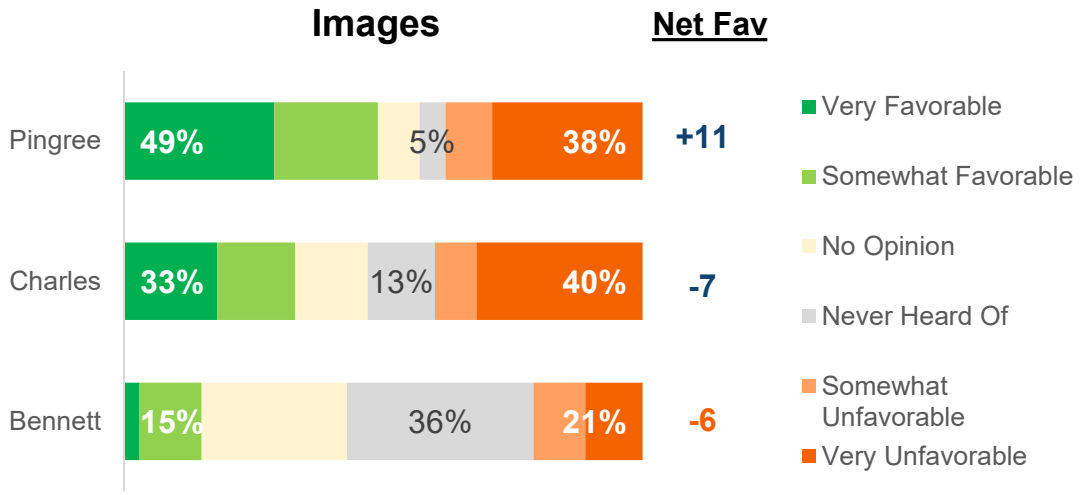


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Net Pingree	**+13**	**+21**	**+7**	**+44**	**+5**	**-2**	**+14**	**-76**	**+9**	**+92**	**-84**	**-73**	**+17**	**+2**	**+90**	**+92**	**+22**	**+1**	**+16**	**-5**	**-8**	**+40**	**+23**	**--**	**+8**	**+28**
Pingree	52	56	49	67	49	45	52	8	46	94	4	9	49	43	94	93	56	46	53	43	42	65	57	45	50	41
Charles	39	35	42	23	44	47	38	84	37	2	88	82	32	41	4	1	34	45	37	48	50	25	34	45	42	13
Bennett	6	6	6	7	5	6	7	6	12	2	4	6	11	13	2	2	5	8	6	7	5	8	5	8	5	32
Other/Und	3	3	3	3	2	2	3	2	5	2	4	3	8	3	0	4	5	1	4	2	3	2	4	2	3	14

Gubernatorial: Images

Hannah Pingree is the most defined candidate in the race for governor, with a positive image at 49% - 38%. Bobby Charles' image is narrowly negative at 33% - 40%. Rick Bennett is largely undefined at 15% - 21%.

- As on the ballot, Pingree is positive with both younger and older voters, best with voters 18-34. Charles is underwater among voters under 50 while split among voters 50+.
- Many of the other demographic differences follow along with differences on how Mainers are planning to vote, with Pingree strongest among women and those with college degrees, and Charles positive among men 50+ and voters without college degrees.



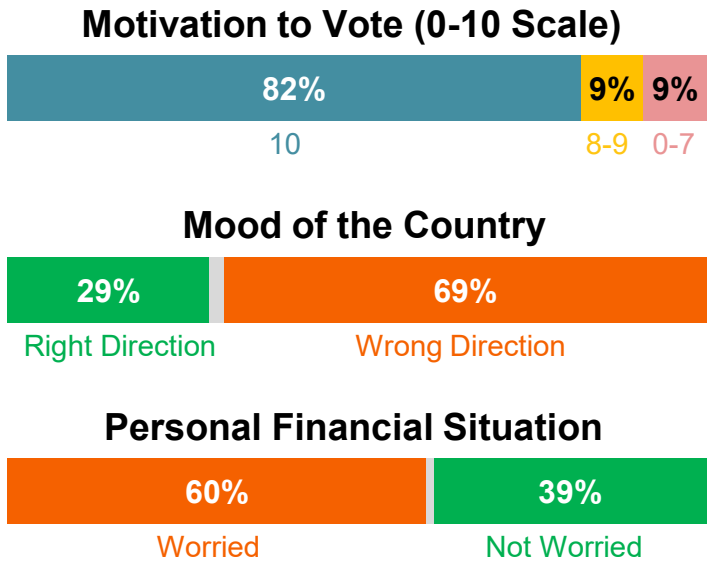
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Pingree Net Fav	+11	+19	+6	+31	+9	-3	+15	-66	+8	+82	-55	-71	+5	+9	+76	+84	+20	+1	+15	-4	-7	+36	+18	+3	+10	+10
Favorable	49	51	48	56	47	44	51	11	44	87	11	11	40	46	85	87	53	45	52	43	38	64	53	44	50	45
Unfavorable	38	32	42	25	38	47	36	77	36	5	66	82	35	37	9	3	33	44	37	47	45	28	35	41	40	35
Charles Net Fav	-7	-15	-2	-34	-1	+1	-5	+57	-5	-64	+60	+55	-13	+1	-65	-62	-15	+2	-9	+7	+11	-31	-16	+4	+1	-13
Favorable	33	28	36	17	36	39	33	69	31	3	70	68	26	35	2	4	27	40	30	43	40	23	27	40	37	18
Unfavorable	40	43	38	51	37	38	38	12	36	67	10	13	39	34	67	66	42	38	39	36	29	54	43	36	36	31
Bennett Net Fav	-6	-5	-7	-7	-4	-13	--	-7	+1	-10	-5	-8	+5	-3	-13	-9	-9	-3	-11	-3	-7	-4	-5	-7	-10	+20
Favorable	15	14	16	13	14	11	21	16	16	14	18	16	16	16	10	16	11	20	11	21	13	19	14	17	12	30
Unfavorable	21	19	23	20	18	24	21	23	15	24	23	24	11	19	23	25	20	23	22	24	20	23	19	24	22	10

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Political environment

Most Maine voters are extremely motivated to vote in November with 82% rating themselves a 10 out of 10. This climbs to 87% among voters 50+ compared to 73% among those under 50.

- The gap on motivation between seniors and voters 18-34 is 20 points.
- Democrats (88%) are more motivated than Republicans (81%), with Independents (74%) less motivated than both partisan groups.
- Only 29% of Maine voters think the country is headed in the right direction compared to 69% who say wrong direction.
- 60% are worried about their personal financial situation with worry high across all age groups. More than two thirds of Swing voters 50+ are worried about their personal financial situation.



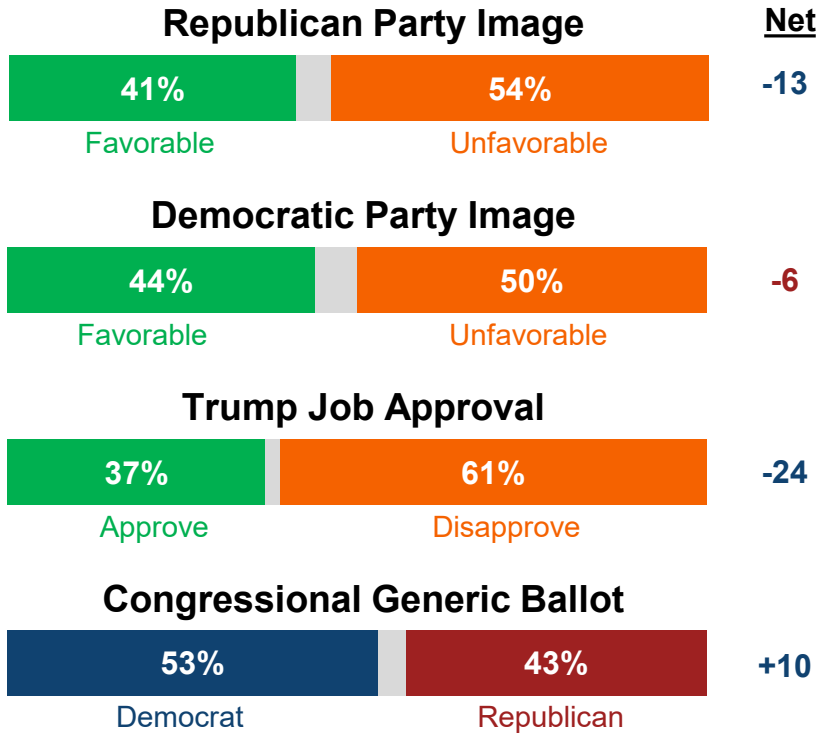
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Motivation: 10	82	73	87	69	76	84	89	81	74	88	67	87	64	81	84	91	84	79	88	85	78	87	83	80	87	70
% Right Direction	29	23	32	16	28	36	28	62	25	3	58	63	20	29	4	2	22	36	25	40	34	21	26	32	31	17
% Worried	60	63	59	63	63	58	59	47	65	68	54	45	69	62	64	70	68	52	66	50	62	58	59	62	64	68

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Partisan environment

While both parties are underwater, the Democratic party (-6) is less unpopular than the Republican party (-13) among Maine likely voters.

- Both parties are double-digits negative with Independents.
- President Trump's job approval is negative at 37% - 61%. He is underwater with each age group.
- The Congressional generic ballot has the Democrats up 10 points statewide. In the 1st District, voters prefer the Democrat by 22-points. In the 2nd District, voters prefer the Republican by 4-points.
- Swing voters 50+, who strongly back Collins and prefer Pingree over Charles, are split on the Congressional generic ballot.



	All likely voters	Voters 18 – 49	Voters 50+	Voters 18-34	Voters 35-49	Voters 50-64	Voters 65+	GOP	Ind	Dem	GOP 18-49	GOP 50+	Ind 18-49	Ind 50+	Dem 18-49	Dem 50+	Women	Men	Women 50+	Men 50+	<Coll	Coll +	CD-1	CD-2	Care-givers 50+	Swing Voters 50+
GOP Net Favorable	-13	-30	-3	-49	-16	+4	-10	+78	-22	-86	+80	+77	-40	-10	-91	-82	-21	-5	-10	+5	+7	-41	-23	-2	-4	-9
Dem Net Favorable	-6	-9	-4	-3	-13	-14	+6	-76	-17	+65	-73	-77	-22	-14	+42	+80	+2	-14	+5	-13	-16	+9	+1	-13	-	+3
Trump Net Approval	-24	-38	-15	-57	-24	-8	-22	+62	-28	-95	+64	+61	-46	-14	-94	-95	-34	-12	-26	-3	-6	-48	-34	-13	-16	-46
Cong Gen: Net Dem	+10	+25	+1	+51	+6	-5	+6	-84	+12	+89	-90	-81	+31	-2	+91	+88	+19	-1	+11	-12	-10	+37	+22	-4	+1	-1

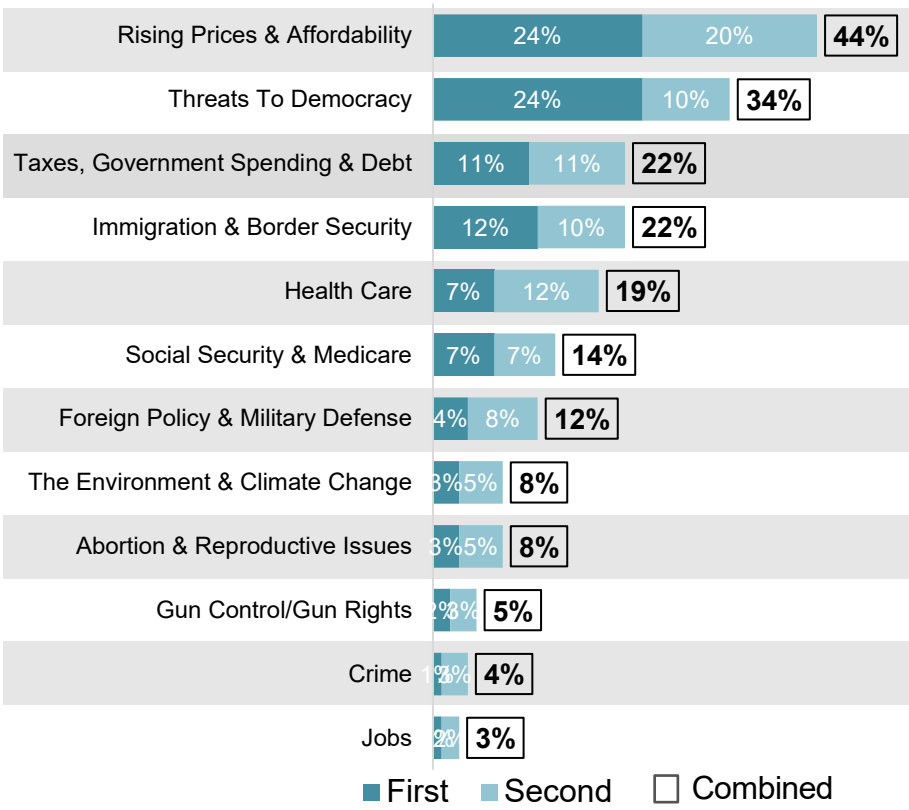


ISSUES DRIVING THE ELECTION

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Most important issues (1st + 2nd choice) determining vote

- Rising prices & affordability is the biggest issue in voting this November, hitting 44% among voters for their 1st or 2nd choice. It is top with most groups, especially voters under 50 and Independents.
- Threats to Democracy finishes in 2nd place, driven by Democrats, who have it as their top issue.
- Immigration, the top issue for Republicans, is tied with Taxes/spending in 3rd place.
- Swing voters 50+ have rising prices/affordability as their top issue followed by Social Security/Medicare.
- Voters prioritizing SS/MC are an up-for-grabs group. They back Pingree in the governor's race by 28-points but pick Collins by a point in the Senate race.

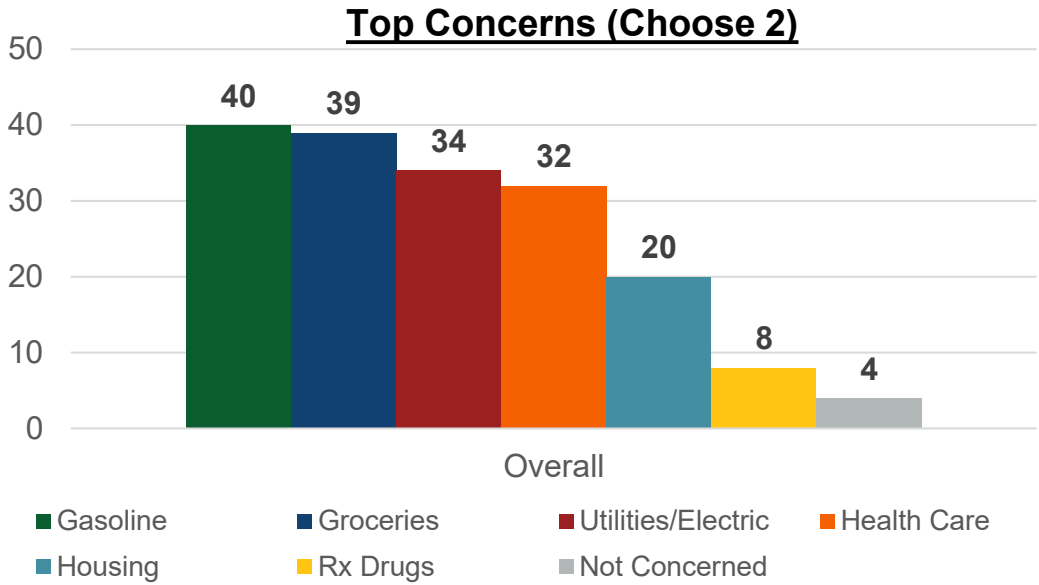


Q29. Now specifically, from the following list, please tell me which issue is personally most important to you in deciding your vote this November? Q30. And which of the remaining issues would be next most important to you personally in deciding your vote this November?	Voters 18-49	Voters 50+	Voters 18-34	Voters 35-49	Voters 50-64	Voters 65+	GOP	Ind	Dem	Women	Men	Women 50+	Men 50+	<Coll	Coll +	CD-1	CD-2	Swing Voters 50+	Net TJ - SC	Net HP - RC
Rising Prices & Affordability	53	38	54	53	43	33	38	48	45	43	44	40	36	44	44	44	43	45	+14	+25
Threats To Democracy	34	33	37	32	34	33	15	31	52	32	36	32	35	26	44	39	28	11	+61	+62
Taxes, Government Spending & Debt	23	22	15	28	27	18	37	25	7	19	26	18	26	24	19	23	22	21	-51	-48
Immigration & Border Security	16	25	9	21	31	20	40	23	4	20	24	22	28	25	16	21	22	15	-80	-78
Health Care	23	17	23	22	16	18	9	20	28	25	13	21	13	19	19	20	19	25	+45	+58
Social Security & Medicare	4	20	3	5	11	28	15	14	13	16	12	22	17	18	9	10	19	33	-1	+28
Foreign Policy & Military Defense	13	11	18	9	9	13	12	12	11	10	13	10	12	10	14	10	14	14	+3	+17
The Environment & Climate Change	9	7	10	8	7	8	2	5	15	8	8	8	7	4	13	9	7	5	--	--
Abortion & Reproductive Issues	10	6	13	8	6	6	4	5	12	11	4	8	4	8	7	8	7	6	--	--
Gun Control/Gun Rights	4	5	5	4	4	6	8	4	3	4	6	4	6	7	2	5	5	5	--	--
Crime	3	5	3	2	7	4	10	3	1	4	5	4	6	5	4	4	5	7	--	--
Jobs	5	3	6	3	3	2	4	4	2	2	4	2	4	2	5	4	2	4	--	--

Top Concerns on Rising Prices & Affordability

There are many concerns on rising prices and affordability among Maine voters, with gasoline narrowly ahead of groceries, then utilities and health care not far behind.

- Gasoline and groceries are essentially tied as the top worry among both voters under and over 50.
- Those 18-34 are unique in their focus on housing costs.
- Utilities like electricity are a higher concern in Maine than other battleground states AARP has polled this cycle.

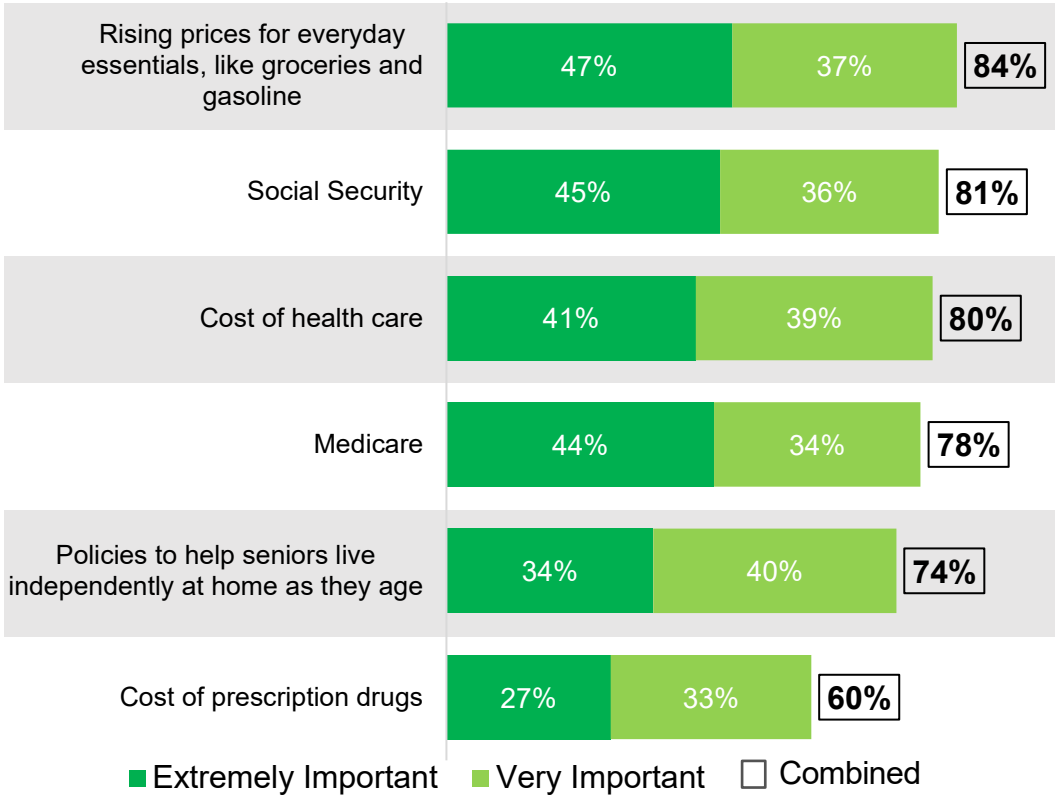


Q32. Which two of the following are you most concerned about in regard to rising prices and affordability? If you are not concerned about any rising prices, please just say so.

	All likely voters	Voters 18 – 49	Voters 50+	Voters 18-34	Voters 35-49	Voters 50-64	Voters 65+	GOP	Ind	Dem	Women	Men	Women 50+	Men 50+	<Coll	Coll +	CD-1	CD-2	Care-givers 50+	Swing Voters 50+	RP & Afford: Top 2 Issue
Gasoline	40	41	39	34	46	41	37	41	41	37	37	43	37	41	40	39	36	44	41	41	47
Groceries	39	41	38	39	43	33	42	36	40	41	41	36	41	34	40	38	38	40	40	41	45
Utilities, like electricity	34	34	35	27	38	37	33	43	34	27	36	32	35	35	35	33	31	37	37	33	37
Health Care	32	30	32	32	29	31	33	22	29	42	35	28	34	30	29	36	34	30	31	31	27
Housing	20	32	13	50	18	19	9	13	20	27	20	21	14	12	18	24	25	15	11	13	22
Prescription drugs	8	6	10	8	4	6	13	9	7	8	9	7	10	9	9	6	7	9	10	18	4

Key issues for voters 50+

- Several issues that have major impacts on voters 50+ will be very important when they vote this November led by rising prices, Social Security, the cost of health care, Medicare, and policies to help seniors live independently as they age.
- Politically, the Senate race is extremely competitive among voters who are focused on these central issues to voters 50+.



Q34-39. Please tell me how important each of the following issues are when deciding your vote this November: extremely important, very important, somewhat important, not too important, or not at all important.	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll+ 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Care-givers 50+	Swing Voters 50+	SS: Major Source 50+	Net TJ - SC	Net HP - RC
Rising prices for everyday essentials, like groceries and gasoline	88	80	85	83	76	85	92	86	82	82	86	86	87	90	-	+17
Social Security	87	75	76	86	74	82	89	82	80	82	80	82	82	91	-2	+16
Cost of health care	85	74	78	81	69	77	93	79	81	79	80	81	84	87	+2	+21
Medicare	83	72	69	86	72	75	87	79	77	78	78	80	81	87	-1	+17
Policies to help seniors live independently at home as they age	81	67	69	79	73	68	80	78	68	76	73	79	75	82	-7	+9
Cost of prescription drugs	68	52	58	62	50	59	72	61	59	59	61	65	64	68	+3	+23

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Protecting voters 50+ — Federal issues

- A candidate who fights to make sure workers get the Social Security they paid for and protects it from cuts gets a massive boost across party lines among voters 50+.
- Older voters in Maine also reward a candidate who will expand Medicare's ability to negotiate on prescription drugs and one who will help family caregivers.

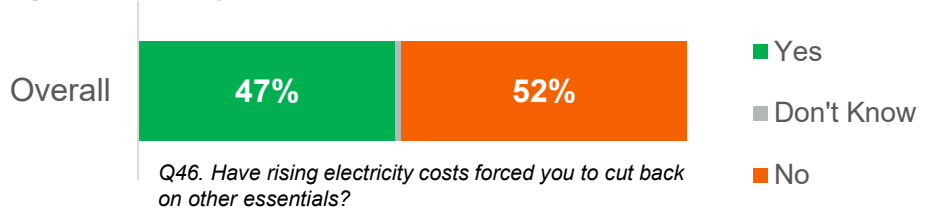
Q40-45: Thinking about issues that could be addressed in Washington, for each of the following statements, please tell me if you would be more likely or less likely to vote for a candidate that advocated this position. If it would have no impact on your vote, just say so.	Much More Likely	Somewhat More Likely	Total More Likely	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll+ 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Care-givers 50+	Swing Voters 50+	SS: Major Source 50+
Making sure workers get the Social Security they paid into and earned through a lifetime of hard work	76%	17%	**93%**	94	92	93	93	91	93	95	92	94	92	94	94	88	96
Protecting Social Security from any cuts such as a reduction in payments, reducing annual increases or raising the retirement age	66%	19%	**85%**	86	83	84	85	84	81	87	85	84	84	85	83	79	91
Expand Medicare's ability to negotiate drug prices to help lower the costs of prescription drugs	52%	32%	**84%**	86	82	79	88	74	82	95	81	89	84	83	83	84	90
Provide support for unpaid family caregivers who are helping their loved ones live independently in their homes	37%	39%	**76%**	77	74	71	79	61	77	89	75	76	76	75	81	75	81
Providing a tax credit for unpaid family caregivers who work to help cover the costs associated with caring for a family member	36%	37%	**73%**	76	69	67	78	65	70	83	70	77	73	73	78	68	79
Provide paid leave so unpaid family caregivers can care for loved ones without losing their job or salary	37%	31%	**68%**	74	62	64	73	53	67	86	67	71	68	68	73	61	76

Protecting Maine voters 50+ — Utilities

Nearly half of Maine voters 50+ say they have been forced to cut back on other essentials due to rising electricity costs.

- Impacts are highest among Swing voters 50+, Independents, those without college degrees and women, but many are feeling the pain of higher electricity costs across groups.
- As a result 97% of Maine voters 50+ say it is important, including 85% who say it is very important, that elected officials work to ensure that utility costs are affordable, especially for Mainers living on a fixed income.

Rising Electricity Costs Forced Cutbacks on Essentials



Q46. Have rising electricity costs forced you to cut back on other essentials?

Work to Ensure Utility Costs Are Affordable



Q47. How important is it that elected officials work to ensure that utility costs are affordable, especially for Mainers living on a fixed income?

Voters 50+	All voters 50+	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll + 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Swing Voters 50+
% Forced to Cut Back by Rising Electricity Costs	47	53	40	53	42	47	54	43	54	37	42	53	55
% Very Important to Ensure Utility Costs Are Affordable	85	89	79	84	86	80	86	88	87	82	82	87	81

Protecting Maine voters 50+ — Independent Aging

Maine voters 50+ are nearly unanimous in saying it is important that elected officials work to increase home and community-based services so older Mainers can live independently at home as they age.

- Nearly two-thirds call this very important with majorities of Maine voters across demographic groups saying it is very important.

Work to Increase HCBS to Live Independently As Age



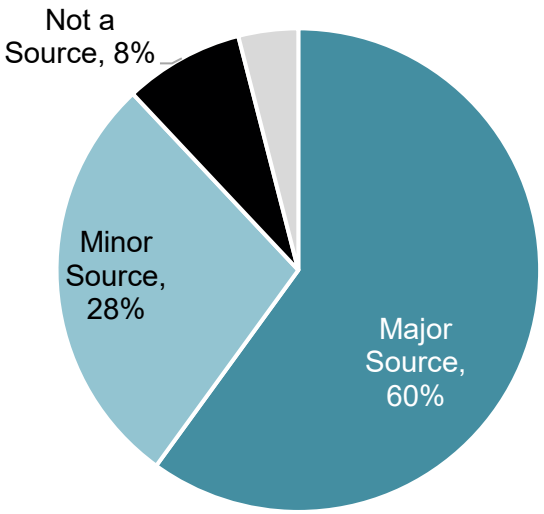
Q48. How important is it that elected officials work to increase home and community-based services so older Mainers can live independently at home as they age?

Voters 50+	All voters 50+	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll + 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Swing Voters 50+
% Very Important to Work to Increase HCBS	63	73	50	56	69	59	51	75	67	56	59	67	70

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Importance of Social Security

- 60% of voters 50+ say Social Security is or will be a major source of income for their household.
- This figure is highest among seniors, and is also very high among women 50+, Swing voters 50+, and in CD-2.



Q51. Is Social Security now, or do you expect it to be, a major source of income for your household, a minor source of income for your household, or not a source of income for your household?



Voters 50+	All voters 50+	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll + 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Swing Voters 50+
Social Security major source	60	67	52	47	72	63	57	60	64	55	53	67	64

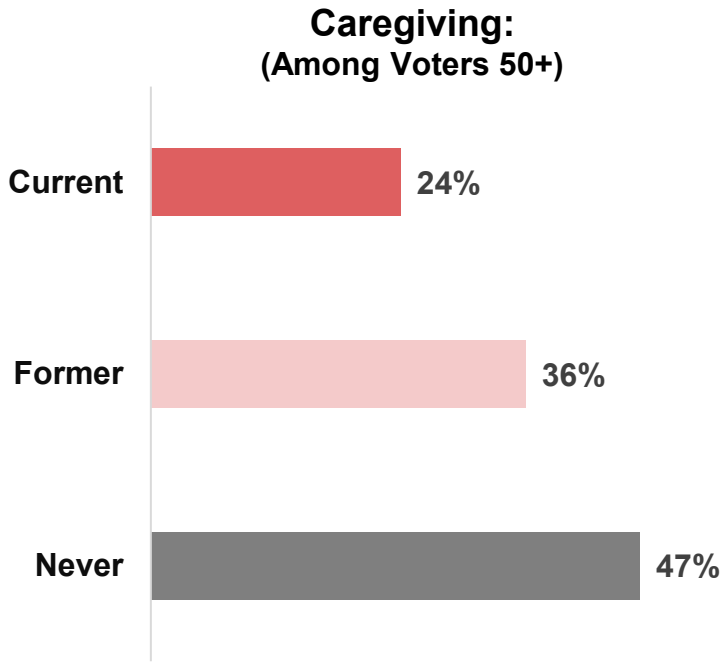
Family caregivers matter

- A 52% majority of Maine voters 50+ are family caregivers – either current or former.
- Women 50+ are even more likely to be family caregivers.

A family caregiver is someone who provides care or assistance to an older or ill adult, or someone with a disability. **Do you consider yourself to be a current or former family caregiver?**

52% yes



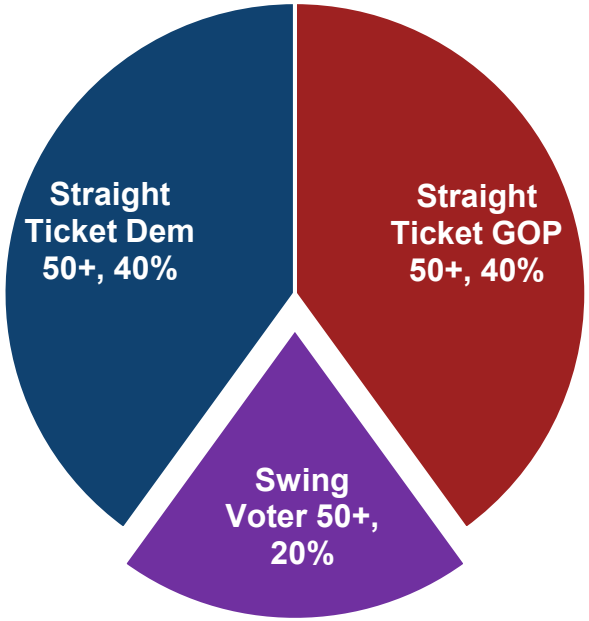


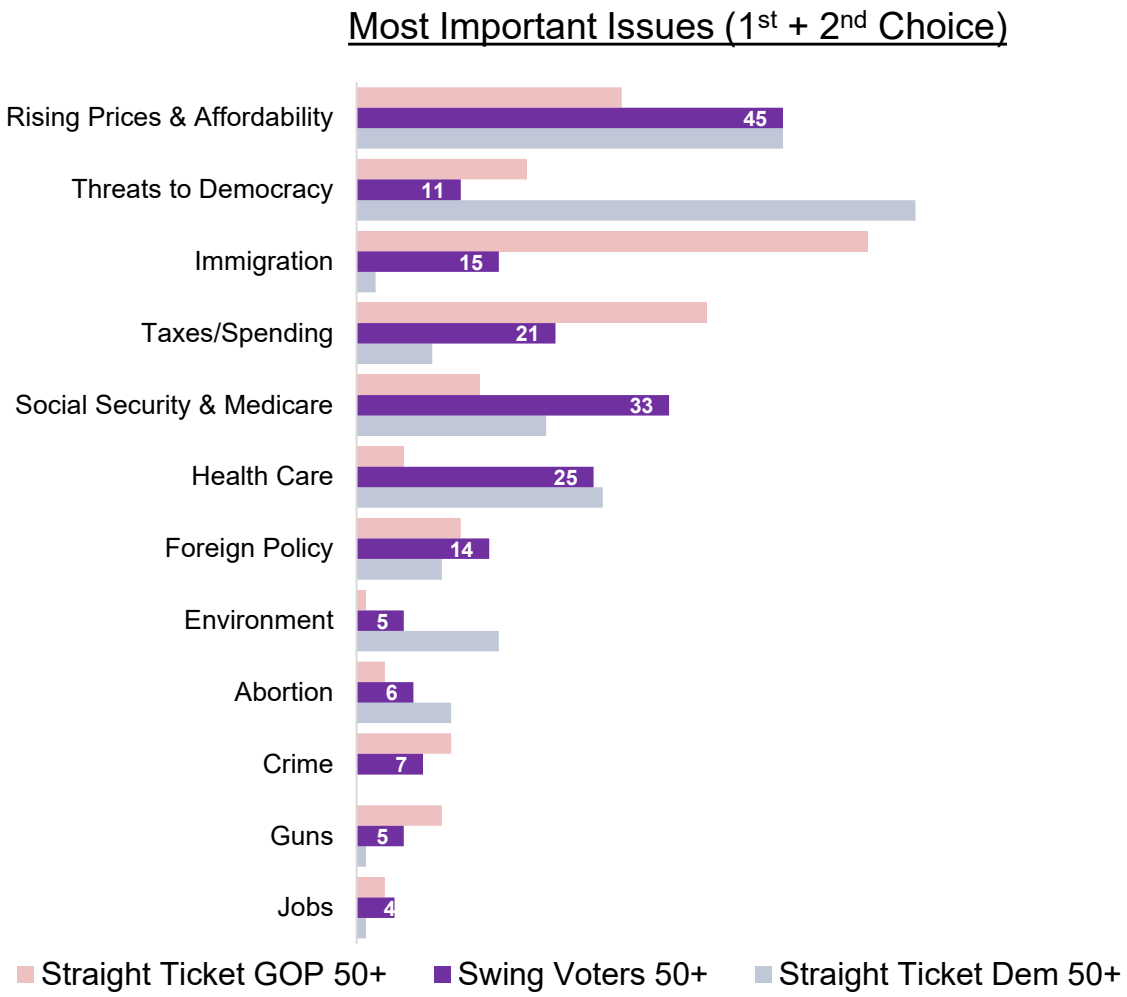
Voters 50+	All voters 50+	Women 50+	Men 50+	Voters 50 – 64	Voters 65+	GOP 50+	Ind 50+	Dem 50+	<Coll 50+	Coll + 50+	CD-1	CD-2	Swing Voters 50+
Family Caregiver	52	60	44	55	50	50	57	52	53	52	48	57	48

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Swing Voters 50+

- 20% of voters 50+ are Swing voters, meaning they do not vote for the Republican or Democrat on all of the three ballots (Governor, Senate, generic Congressional).
- These voters are divided politically: 40% are Independents, 32% are Republicans, 29% are Democrats.
- They are dialed in on issues related to finances and health: their top issues are affordability, Social Security & Medicare, and Health care.





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Maine voters 18+

FabrizioWard + IMPACT RESEARCH

AARP commissioned the bipartisan polling team of Fabrizio Ward (R) & Impact Research (D) to conduct a survey of 982 likely voters statewide. The survey was done between September 20-22, 2026. The interviews were conducted via live interviewer on cell phone (40%) and landline (15%), as well as SMS-to-web (45%). The sample was randomly drawn from the Maine voter list. The margin of sampling error at the 95% confidence level for the 982 statewide sample is ±3.1%.

Due to rounding, answer choices may not always add up to 100%. Data is specified in the report that it is among either the 18+ or 50+ universe.

For more information about this survey, contact Kate Bridges at kbridges@aarp.org. **Media inquiries** Maine media contact Jane Margesson at jmargesson@aarp.org; national media contact media@aarp.org.

GENDER



53% female

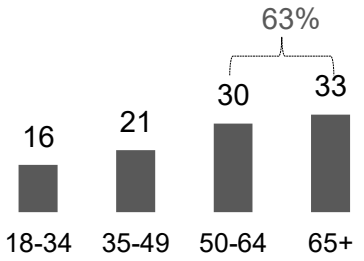
47% male

RACE

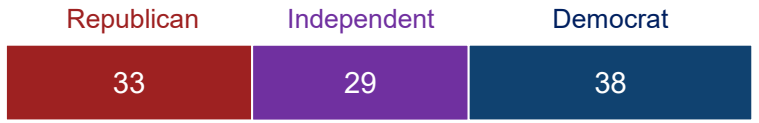


92% White
2% Hispanic
6% Other

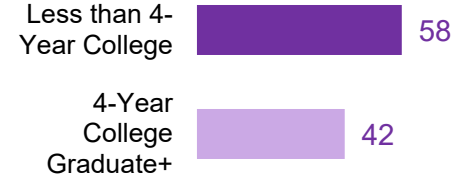
AGE



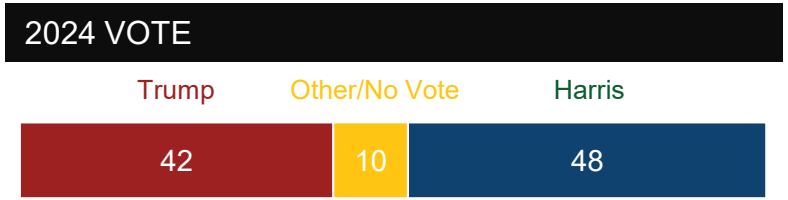
PARTY ID



EDUCATION



2024 VOTE



AARP (Among Voters 50+)



37% are AARP members



For national media inquiries, please contact AARP External Relations at:
media@aarp.org

For Maine media inquiries, please contact:
Jane Margesson at jmargesson@aarp.org

For questions about this study, please contact:
Kate Bridges at kbridges@aarp.org

This research was designed and executed by AARP Research

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